

Page 1 of 6 · An Empty Thread

Ted-E-Bear taps his vest before every adventure. Tap-tap means, ‘I can try.’ But this morning his paw finds an empty spot. His lucky button is gone. Corgi-on-the-Cob sniffs the curling threads, then sneezes a tiny pop of corn. The first clues are waiting beside Ted’s bed.



Page 2 of 6 · The Muddy Clues

Outside, fresh paw marks cross the path. Ted’s tummy feels fluttery. What if the trail is too long? Corgi presses his nose to the first print and gives a hopeful bark-pop. Ted takes one careful step, then another. Trying feels a little like courage.



Page 3 of 6 · Acorns in Order

Beneath the oak, numbered acorns sit in a neat row. One has rolled into the clover, leaving a gap. Corgi wants to chase it, but Ted studies the caps. ‘Wait,’ he says. ‘The row is trying to tell us something.’

Sequence: 3, 4, ?, 6



Page 4 of 6 · The Wobbly Bridge

A little bridge stretches over the creek. One side has a short line of stepping planks; the other has a longer line. Ted does not like wobbling. Corgi trots onto the side with more places to step, then turns and waits. Ted touches the empty spot on his vest. ‘I can still try.’



Page 5 of 6 · A Golden Glint

On the hill, picnic napkins flap in the breeze. Something gold flashes beneath them, then disappears. Corgi’s tail starts popping so quickly that Ted laughs. Together they lift each napkin while the warm smell of honey-oat buns drifts from the basket.



Page 6 of 6 · Lucky Enough

The button was holding down the picnic cloth all along. Ted sews it back onto his vest, then pauses. He crossed the path, solved the acorns, and braved the bridge without it. Corgi leans close. Tap-tap. ‘Lucky button,’ says Ted, ‘meet my brave paws.’

Questions for Ted-E-Bear and the Button Trail

Read the story together first. Use the page prompts and the questions after reading. Answers are below the dotted line: fold them under or cover them while reading.

Page 1 · An Empty Thread

How many loose threads curl from Ted’s vest?

Choices: 1 · 2 · 3

Page 2 · The Muddy Clues

How many prints cross the path?

Choices: 3 · 4 · 5

Page 3 · Acorns in Order

Which number belongs in the gap?

Sequence: 3, 4, ?, 6 Choices: 3 · 5 · 7

Page 4 · The Wobbly Bridge

Which group has more?

Choices: 5 planks · 7 planks · They match

Page 5 · A Golden Glint

How many napkins hid the golden glint?

Choices: 8 · 9 · 10

Page 6 · Lucky Enough

Two equal groups of five make how many treats?

Choices: 8 · 10 · 12

After reading

Was the button Ted’s only kind of luck?

Answers (fold under before reading)

Page 1: 2. Two threads — and one points towards the door.

Page 2: 4. Four prints lead straight to the Great Oak.

Page 3: 5. Five! The runaway acorn points towards the picnic hill.

Page 4: 7 planks. Seven steady planks carry both friends safely across.

Page 5: 9. Nine napkins lifted — and there is Ted’s button!

Page 6: 10. Two fives make ten — enough for a brave picnic together.

After reading: Ted discovered that his own brave paws, and a patient friend, helped him finish the trail.